Appendix: Example of a Work Agreement

Group Name: roadrunner

Members:

- Jack S, 56606767
- Rick W, 23307416
- Nik D, 5705

Schedule:

- Weekly in-person meeting Tuesdays or Thursdays at 1pm in IONA B151
- Weekly lab on Wednesdays at 1pm in IONA B151
- Weekly Instagram check in Fridays at 3pm

Communications:

- Groupchat responded to within 1 business day
- Check and respond to group chat once per day
- Github link: https://github.com/jackhtsong/cogs-300-roadrunner

Effort expectations:

- We all plan to achieve 80% in this class
- We will spend a minimum of 4 hours a week on lab work (including lab time)

Roles:

- We will split projects into issues and whoever wants to take an issue can do it.

Feedback:

- We will use the "standup" method (https://geekbot.com/blog/daily-standup-meeting) on Tuesday/Thursday meetings to inform each other of what we're working on and what we need for success.
- We will give each other feedback using the "compliment sandwich" method, i.e. two good things for every bad thing.
- We will use non-violent communication (https://www.cnvc.org/) to try to come to consensus on difficult issues for the most part.
- However, if consensus is impossible, we will revert to Robert's Rules (https://www.boardeffect.com/blog/roberts-rules-of-order-cheat-sheet) and abide by a majority vote.
- Each Friday, we will use the "postmortem" method to reflect on what worked well about working together that week, what didn't work well, and what we will improve.

Signed: Jack, Nik, Rick

Appendix: Paul's personal group work methods

Postmortem method: You explicitly meet for a critique session, looking both at the product and the process of working together that week. *Everyone is required* to say one thing that worked well, and one thing that did not work well. This develops a habit of saying both "good" and "bad" things, either of which can be scary or seem impossible for some people.

Topic-detail brainstorm: You have a pre-brainstorm where you brainstorm on the topics of conversation, organize the topics, and *avoid getting into the details*. Then, someone volunteers to be the facilitator and guides the group from topic to topic. This develops a habit of separating the meta-discussion from the detailed discussion.

Secret bad ideas: During a brainstorm, everyone's ideas are accepted *without comment*. Every idea is considered helpful and valid and is written down on a whiteboard. Everyone is *required* to have and say out loud two "bad" ideas, but they are never allowed to say which ones were their "bad" ideas. This develops a habit of allowing creativity by saying and accepting wild ideas.

White-black sheep ideation: If a specific design solution is being discussed, an opposite design solution is discussed with just as much seriousness and rigour. Sometimes, the team splits internally to work on the separate design solutions without influencing each other. This develops the habit of not focusing on a single design solution too much.

Free association: Sometimes, a problem just needs free association. Team members say literally any words one after another until an idea emerges. This develops the habit of relaxing for creativity to flow.

Seven things: One person names a category of things and the next person says seven things that fit into that category as quickly as possible. After each thing, the group claps and counts. However, the category needs to be silly, difficult or an anti-category, e.g., seven things that are <u>not</u> red, or seven things that would live inside a shoe, or seven things that my dog would never sniff. The *only* objective is speed and poise: the speaker wants to go as quickly as possible and overcome their internal fear of being "right." In fact, even repeated answers are fine! Eventually, you can incorporate other elements into the exercise, like being more descriptive, or answering using a character.

Pair work: One person is the "driver" and the other the "navigator." Both people are 100% focused on achieving a task together. The driver does the work directly, the navigator facilitates the work by checking for mistakes, preparing materials that are needed next, articulating what the driver might be thinking. This is commonly done with coding, but can also work for writing and other creative projects.